Stellenbosch 5v5 Ultimate Frisbee Rules

Based off:
WFDF Rules of Ultimate 2025-2028

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Introduction

Stellenbosch Ultimate Frisbee League in a 5v5 format is a fast-paced, non-contact team sport that combines elements of rugby sevens and netball. Two teams of 5 players compete on a field, passing the disc to advance toward the opposing team's end zone to score points. Like in netball, you cannot run while holding the disc—you must stop and pass to a teammate. Similar to rugby sevens, the game is continuous, meaning possession quickly switches between offence and defence when a pass is dropped, intercepted, or goes out of bounds.

This format emphasizes quick decision-making, teamwork, agility, and endurance. The game encourages spatial awareness, strategic movement, and accurate throws rather than physical contact, making it accessible and fun for all skill levels. It is played on a rectangular field, 25m wide and 65m long. Games are typically played to 15 goals or around 45 minutes.

Whether you're new to disc sports or have experience in netball or rugby, you'll find 5v5 Ultimate exciting and easy to pick up!

1. Spirit of the Game

1.1. Ultimate is a non-contact, self-officiated sport. All players are responsible for administering and adhering to the rules. Ultimate relies upon a Spirit of the Game that places the responsibility for fair play on every player.

1.2. It is trusted that no player will intentionally break the rules; thus there are no harsh penalties for inadvertent breaches, but rather a method for resuming play in a manner which simulates what would most likely have occurred had there been no breach.

1.3. Players should be mindful of the fact that they are acting as referees in any arbitration between teams. Players must:

- 1.3.1. know and abide by both the rules and the spirit of the rules;
- 1.3.2. be fair-minded and objective;
- 1.3.3. be truthful;
- 1.3.4. explain their viewpoint clearly and briefly;
- 1.3.5. allow opponents an opportunity to speak;
- 1.3.6. listen to and consider opponent's viewpoint;
- 1.3.7. use respectful words and body language with consideration of potential cultural differences;
- 1.3.8. resolve disputes efficiently;
- 1.3.9. make calls in a consistent manner throughout the game; and
- 1.3.10. only make a call where a breach is significant enough to make a difference to the outcome of the action, or where a player's safety is at risk.

1.4. Highly competitive play is encouraged, but should never sacrifice the mutual respect between players, adherence to the agreed-upon rules of the game, player safety or the basic joy of play.

1.5. In the case where a novice player is involved in a breach and does not know the rules, experienced players should assist to explain the breach.

1.6. An experienced player, who offers advice on rules and guides on-field arbitration, may supervise games involving beginners or younger players.

1.7. Calls should be discussed by the players directly involved in the play, and by players who had the best perspective on the play.

- 1.7.1. If a player who was not directly involved believes that a team-mate has made an incorrect call, or caused a foul or violation, they should inform their team-mate. Non-players, apart from the captains, should refrain from getting involved. However players may seek other peoples' perspectives to clarify the rules, and to assist players to make the appropriate call.

1.8. Players and captains are solely responsible for making and resolving all calls.

1.9. If after discussion players cannot agree, or it is not clear and obvious:

- 1.9.1. what occurred in a play, or
- 1.9.2. what would most likely have occurred in a play,

the disc must be returned to the last non-disputed thrower.

2. Playing Field

2.1. The playing field is a rectangular area with dimensions and zones as shown on Figure 1 and should be essentially flat, free of obstructions and afford reasonable player safety.

2.2. The perimeter lines are not part of the playing field.

2.3. The goal lines are the lines that separate the central zone from the end zones and are part of the central zone.

2.4. The immediate surroundings of the playing field shall be kept clear of movable objects. If play is obstructed by non-players or objects within three (2) metres of the perimeter line, any obstructed player or thrower in possession may call "Violation".

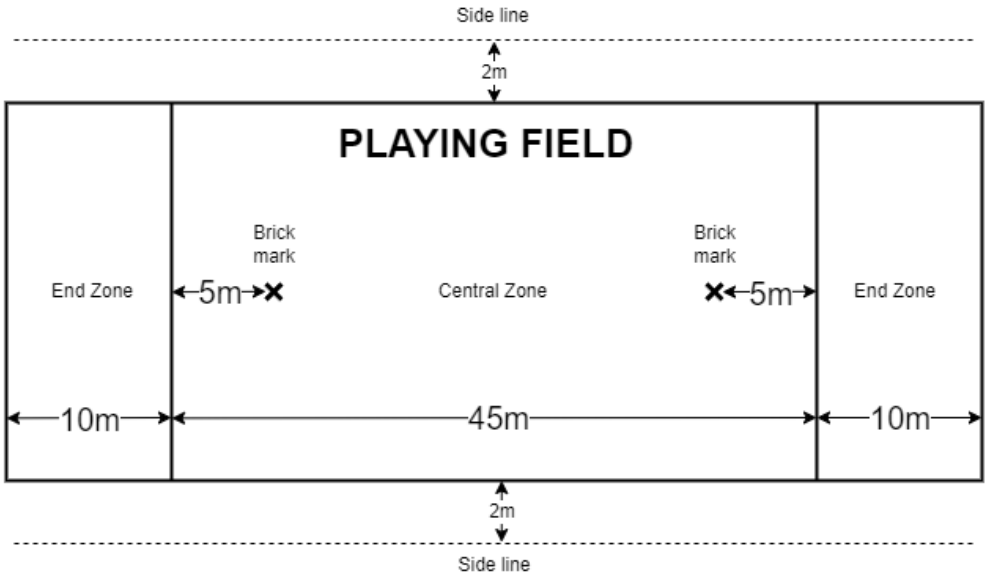

Figure 1: Playing field

3. Equipment

3.1. Match discs should be 175g discs. If none are available, any flying disc that is acceptable to both captains may be used.

3.2. Each player must wear kit that represents their team.

3.3. Shoes: Flat soled or barefoot. **NO CLEATS**.

4. Game

4.1. Games consist of two halves of 20 minutes with a 5 minute half time.

4.2. Half time occurs either after *Point half* or *Time half*:

4.2.1. Point half: When a team first scores eight (8) goals

4.2.2. Time half: After the first 20 minutes of play time.

4.3. If points half occur, the remaining time from the first half gets added to the second half.

4.4. A game is finished and won by the first team to score fifteen (15) goals. Or the points leader after the 40 minutes of game time has elapsed.

5. Teams

5.1. Each team will put a maximum of five (5) players and a minimum of four (4) players on the field during each point.

5.2. A team may make unlimited substitutions after a goal is scored and before their team signals readiness for the pull.

6. Scoring

6.1. A goal is scored if an in-bounds player catches a legal pass and:

6.1.1. all their ground contacts are entirely within their attacking end zone, or for an airborne player, all of their first simultaneous points of ground contact after catching the disc are entirely within their attacking end zone, and

6.1.2. they subsequently establish possession of the disc, and maintain the catch throughout all ground contact related to the catch.

6.2. If a player believes a goal has been scored, they may call “goal” and play stops. After a contested or retracted goal call play must restart with a check and the call is deemed to have been made when the player established possession.

6.3. The time at which a goal is deemed to have been scored is when the player established possession.

7. Starting a Game

7.1. Representatives of the two teams fairly determine (from a coin or disc flip) which team first chooses either:
- 7.1.1. whether to receive or throw the initial pull; or
- 7.1.2. which end zone they will initially defend.

7.2. The other team is given the remaining choice.

7.3. At the start of the second half, these initial selections are switched.

8. The Pull

8.1. At the start of the game, after half-time or after a score, play commences with a throw by the defence, called a "pull".

8.2. The pull may be made only after both teams have signalled their readiness by having the puller and a player on offence raise a hand above their head.

8.3. After signalling readiness all defensive players must keep their feet entirely behind the vertical plane of the goal line until the pull is released.

8.4. If a team breaches ("**false start**") or ("**offside**") the opposing team may call the relevant violation. This must be called before the offence touches the disc.
- 8.4.1. If the offence chooses to call offside, they must let the disc hit the ground untouched and then resume play as if a brick has been called (no check is required).

8.5. No player on the defensive team may touch the disc after a pull until a member of the offensive team contacts the disc or the disc hits the ground.

8.6. If an offensive player, in-bounds or out-of-bounds, touches the disc before it hits the ground, and the offensive team fails to subsequently establish possession, that is a turnover (a "**dropped pull**").

8.7. If an offensive player catches the pull and subsequently establishes possession, they must establish a pivot point at the location on the playing field nearest to where possession is established, even if that pivot point is in their defending end zone.

8.8. If the disc initially contacts the playing field and never becomes out-of-bounds, the thrower must establish a pivot point where the disc stops, even if that pivot point is in their defending end zone.

8.9. If the disc initially contacts the playing field and then becomes out-of-bounds without contacting an offensive player, the thrower must establish a pivot point where the disc first crossed the perimeter line, or the nearest location in the central zone if that pivot point would be in their defending end zone.
- 8.9.1. If the disc does contact an offensive player before it becomes out-of-bounds the thrower must establish a pivot point where the disc first crossed the perimeter line, even if that pivot point is in their defending end zone.

8.10. If the disc contacts the out-of-bounds area without first touching the playing field or an offensive player, the thrower may establish a pivot point either at the brick mark closest to their defending end zone, or at the location on the central zone closest to where the disc went out-of-bounds the binding brick option must be signalled before the disc is picked up. It must be signalled by any offensive player fully extending one arm overhead, and they should call "**brick**".

9. Out-of-Bounds

9.1. The entire playing field is in-bounds. The perimeter lines are not part of the playing field and are out-of- bounds. All non-players are part of the out-of-bounds area.

9.2. An offensive player who is not out-of-bounds is in-bounds.
- 9.2.1. An airborne player retains their in-bounds/out-of-bounds status until that player contacts the playing field or the out-of-bounds area.
- 9.2.2. A player who has caught the disc, who contacts the playing field and then contacts an out-of-bounds area, is still considered in-bounds, as long as they maintain the catch until they establish possession.
  - 9.2.2.1. If they leave the playing field, they must establish a pivot point at the location on the

playing field where they crossed the perimeter line.

9.2.3. A thrower who contacts an out-of-bounds area is considered in-bounds until they make a pass.

9.3. The following are out-of-bounds turnovers, and no catch is deemed to have occurred:

9.3.1. any part of an offensive receiver is out-of-bounds when they contact the disc; or

9.3.2. after catching the disc while airborne, an offensive receiver's first contact is out-of-bounds while still in contact with the disc.

9.4. A disc becomes out-of-bounds when it first contacts the out-of-bounds area or contacts an out-of-bounds offensive player.

9.5. A disc that has been caught by an offensive player has the same in/out-of-bounds status as that player. If the disc is simultaneously caught by more than one offensive player, one of them being out-of-bounds, the disc is out-of-bounds.

9.6. The disc may fly outside a perimeter line and return to the playing field, and players may go out-of-bounds to make a play on the disc.

10. Receivers and Positioning

10.1. A "catch" occurs when a player has a non-spinning disc trapped between at least two body parts. A catch can enable a player to establish possession of the disc.

10.1.1. If the player fails to maintain the catch due to subsequent ground contact related to the catch, or contact related to the catch with a team-mate or a legitimately positioned opposition player, possession is deemed to have not occurred.

10.2. If offensive and defensive players catch the disc simultaneously, the offence retains possession.

10.3. A player in an established position is entitled to remain in that position and must not be contacted by an opposing player.

10.4. Every player is entitled to occupy any position on the field not occupied by any opposing player, provided that they do not initiate contact in taking such a position, and are not moving in a reckless or dangerously aggressive manner.

10.4.1. However when the disc is in the air a player may not move in a manner solely to prevent an opponent from taking an unoccupied path to make a play on the disc.

10.5. All players must attempt to avoid initiating contact with other players, and there is no situation where a player may justify initiating contact. This includes avoiding initiating contact with a stationary opponent, or an opponent's expected position based on their established speed and direction.

10.5.1. "Making a play for the disc" is not a valid excuse for initiating contact with other players.

10.5.2. Before a player dives, leaps or jumps away from their position, they must be reasonably certain they will not initiate contact with an opponent.

10.5.3. If a player is not reasonably certain that they will be able to make a legal play at the disc before an opponent who is moving in a legal manner, they must adjust their movements to avoid initiating contact. If that adjustment is made, the result of the play still stands.

10.6. The player who initiates contact is deemed to be the player who:

10.6.1. arrived at the point of contact after the opponent had already established a legitimate position at that point (either a stationary or moving opponent), or

10.6.2. adjusted their movements in a way that created unavoidable contact with an opponent moving in a legal manner, when taking into account all players' established position, speed and direction.

10.6.3. If it is unclear which player initiated contact, and one of the players dived, leaped or jumped away from their position, that player is deemed to have initiated contact.

10.7. Some minor contact may occur as two or more players move towards a single point simultaneously. Minor contact should be minimized but is not considered a foul.

10.8. Players may not use their extended arms or legs to obstruct the movement of opposing players.

11. State of Play

11.1. Any player may attempt to stop a disc from rolling or sliding after it has hit the ground.

11.1.1. If, in attempting to stop such a disc, a player significantly alters the disc's position, the

opposition
may request that the pivot point be established at the location where the disc was contacted.

11.2. After a turnover, and after the pull, an offensive player must move at walking pace or faster to directly retrieve the disc and establish a pivot point.
- 11.2.1. After a turnover the thrower must establish a pivot point within the following time limits, if the disc did not become out-of-bounds, and the disc's location is:
  - 11.2.1.1. in the central zone – within ten (10) seconds of the disc coming to rest.
  - 11.2.1.2. in an end zone – within twenty (20) seconds of the disc coming to rest.
- 11.2.2. If the offence breaches the above rules, the defence may give a warning "Delay of Game".
- 11.2.3. The defence must not move in a manner that obstructs the offence from taking possession of the disc or establishing a pivot point.
- 11.2.4. If players cannot agree on the correct pivot location, the relevant midpoint between the two proposed pivot locations must be used.

12. Turnovers

12.1. A turnover that transfers possession of the disc from one team to the other occurs when:
- 12.1.1. the disc contacts the ground while it is not in the possession of an offensive player (a "**down**");
  - 12.1.1.1. however it is not "down" if a receiver catches a pass before the disc contacts the ground, and maintains the catch while the disc is in contact with the ground.
- 12.1.2. a defensive player establishes possession of a pass (an "**interception**");
- 12.1.3. the disc becomes out-of-bounds (an "**out-of-bounds**" or "**out**"); or
- 12.1.4. during the pull, the offence touches the disc before it hits the ground, and subsequently fails to establish possession of the disc (a "**dropped pull**").

12.2. A turnover that transfers possession of the disc from one team to the other, and results in a stoppage of play, occurs when:
- 12.2.1. there is an accepted offensive receiving foul;
- 12.2.2. the thrower has not released the pass before the marker first starts to say the word "ten" in the stall count (a "**stall-out**");
- 12.2.3. the disc is intentionally transferred from one offensive player to another without ever being completely untouched by both players (a "**handover**");
- 12.2.4. the thrower intentionally deflects a pass to themselves off another player (a "**deflection**");
- 12.2.5. in attempting a pass, the thrower catches the disc after release prior to the disc being contacted
  by another player (a "**self-catch**");

12.3. If a player determines a turnover has occurred they must make the appropriate call immediately. If the opposition disagrees they may call "**contest**" and play must stop. If, after discussion, players cannot agree or it is unclear what occurred in the play, the disc must be returned to the last non-disputed thrower. After a "**stall-out**" call:
- 12.3.1. If the thrower still has possession of the disc, but they believe a fast count occurred in such a manner that they did not have a reasonable opportunity to call fast count before a stall-out, the play is treated as either an accepted defensive breach or a contested stall-out.
- 12.3.2. If the thrower made a completed pass, the thrower can contest if they believe it was not a "**stall- out**", or there was a fast count immediately prior to the "**stall-out**".
- 12.3.3. If the thrower contests a stall-out but also attempts a pass, and the pass is incomplete, then the turnover stands and play restarts with a check.

12.4. Any offensive player may establish possession of the disc after a turnover, except:
- 12.4.1. after an "**interception**" turnover, in which case the player who made the interception must maintain possession; and
- 12.4.2. after an accepted receiving foul caused by the offence, in which case the fouled player must establish possession.

12.5. If the player in possession after a turnover, or after a pull that has already hit the ground, intentionally drops the disc, places the disc on the ground, or transfers possession of the disc, they must re-establish possession and restart play with a check.

12.6. After a turnover, the turnover location is where:

12.6.1. the disc has come to a stop or is picked up by an offensive player; or
12.6.2. the intercepting player stops; or
12.6.3. the thrower was located at the time of the call.
12.6.4. the offensive player was located.
12.6.5. the accepted offensive receiving foul occurred.

12.7. If the turnover location is in the offence's attacking end zone, the thrower must establish a pivot point at the nearest location on the goal line.

12.8. If the turnover location is in the offence's defending end zone, the thrower may choose where to establish a pivot point:
12.8.1. at the turnover location, by staying at the turnover location or faking a pass; or
12.8.2. at the nearest location on the goal line to the turnover location, by moving from the turnover location.
12.8.3. Immediate movement, staying at the turnover location, faking a pass, or signaling the goal line option, determines where to establish a pivot point and cannot be reversed.

12.9. If, after an accepted turnover, play has continued unknowingly, play stops and the disc is returned to the turnover location, players resume their positions at the time the turnover occurred and play restarts with a check.

13. Stall Count

13.1. The marker administers a stall count on the thrower by announcing "Stalling" and then counting from one (1) to ten (10). The interval between the start of each number in the stall count must be at least one
(1) second.

13.2. The stall count must be verbally and clearly communicated to the thrower.

13.3. The marker may only start and continue a stall count when:
13.3.1. Play is live, or once a pivot point is established after a turnover;
13.3.2. They are within three (3) metres of the thrower's pivot point, or the pivot location if the thrower is not at that location; and

13.4. If the marker moves beyond the appropriate three (3) metre radius, or a different player becomes the marker, the stall count must be restarted at "Stalling one (1)".

13.5. After a stoppage in play the stall count is resumed as follows:
13.5.1. After an accepted breach by the defence the stall count restarts at "**Stalling one (1)**".
13.5.2. After an accepted breach by the offence the stall count restarts at maximum nine (9).
13.5.3. After a contested stall-out the stall count restarts at "**Stalling eight (8)**".
13.5.4. After continuation of play from a violation stoppage the stall count restarts at "**Stalling one (1)**".
13.5.5. After all other calls, including "**pick**", the stall count restarts at maximum six (6). However:
13.5.5.1. If there is a call involving the thrower, and a separate receiving breach, and the disc is returned to the thrower, the stall count is resumed based on the outcome of the call involving the thrower.
13.5.5.2. If there is a violation called related to The Check (Section 11), the stall count resumes at the same count that was determined prior to that violation.

14. The Check

14.1. Whenever play stops during a point for a foul, violation, contested turnover, specified turnover, contested goal, stoppage, discussion, or at the completion of a time-out, play must restart as quickly as possible with a check. The check may only be delayed for the discussion of a call.

14.2. Player positioning after a call (except in the case of a time-out, and unless specified otherwise):
14.2.1. If play stops before a pass is thrown, all players must return to the location they held when the call was made.
14.2.2. If play stops after a pass is thrown, then:
14.2.2.1. if the disc is returned to the thrower, all players must return to the location they held when the thrower released the pass, or the time of the call, whichever is earlier.

14.2.2.2. if the result of the play stands all players must return to the location they held when either a player established possession, or the disc hit the ground.
14.2.2.3. if a player other than the thrower gains possession as a result of an accepted breach, all players must return to the location they held when the breach occurred.
14.2.3. All players must remain stationary in that location until the disc is checked in.

14.3. Any player may briefly extend a stoppage of play to fix faulty equipment, but active play may not be stopped for this purpose.

14.4. Prior to the check the person checking the disc in, and the nearest opposition player, must verify that their own team-mates are ready, and positioned.

14.5. If there is an unnecessary delay in checking the disc in, the opposition may give a warning ("**Delay of Game**"). If the delay continues, the team that gave the warning may check the disc in by calling "**Disc In**", without verification from the opposition, but only if the team checking the disc in are all stationary, and positioned.

14.6. To restart play with a check:
14.6.1. when the thrower has the disc:
14.6.1.1. if there is a defender within reach, the defender must touch the disc.
14.6.1.2. if there is not a defender within reach, the thrower must touch the disc to the ground and may call "**Disc In**".

14.7. A player may call a violation regarding the check if an opponent:
14.7.1. attempts a pass without an appropriate check; or
14.7.2. restarts play without verification from their nearest opposition player; or
14.7.3. is moving immediately prior to the check; or
14.7.4. was not in the appropriate position.

14.8. After this violation call any pass does not count regardless of whether it is complete or incomplete, and possession reverts back to the thrower.

15. Calling Fouls, Infractions and Violations

15.1. Only the player fouled may claim a foul, by calling "**Foul**".

15.2. In general only the thrower may claim an infraction, by calling the specific name of the infraction.
15.2.1. However any offensive player may call a double team, and any defensive player may call a travel infraction.

15.3. Any opposing player may claim a violation, by calling the specific name of the violation or "**Violation**", unless specified otherwise by the particular rule.

15.4. When a foul or violation call is made that stops play, players must stop play by visibly or audibly communicating the stoppage as soon as they are aware of the call and all players should echo calls on the field. If play has stopped for a discussion without any call having been made, a call is deemed to have been made when the discussion started.

15.5. Calls must be made immediately after the breach is recognised.

15.6. After a player initiates a stoppage incorrectly, including after mishearing a call, not knowing the rules, or not making the call immediately:
15.6.1. if the opposition gains or retains possession, any subsequent play stands.
15.6.2. if the opposition does not gain or retain possession, the disc must be returned to the last non-disputed thrower.

15.7. If the player against whom the foul, infraction or violation has been called disagrees that it occurred, or does not think it is a correct call, they may call "**Contest**".

15.8. If a player making any call subsequently determines that their call was incorrect, they can retract the call, by calling "**Retracted**". Play resumes as if an accepted breach has been caused by that player.

16. Fouls

16.1. **Dangerous Play:**
16.1.1. Actions demonstrating reckless disregard for the safety of fellow players, or posing significant

risk of injury to fellow players, or other dangerously aggressive behaviours, are considered dangerous play and must be treated as a foul, regardless of whether or when contact occurs.

16.2. **Receiving Fouls:**

16.2.1. A Receiving Foul occurs when a player initiates non-minor contact with an opponent before, while, or directly after, either player makes a play on the disc. Contact with an opponent's arms or hands, that occurs after the disc has been caught, or after the opponent can no longer make a play on the disc, is not a sufficient basis for a foul, but should be avoided.

16.2.2. After an accepted receiving foul the fouled player gains possession at the location of the breach, even if that location is in an end zone, and play restarts with a check. If, after the check the stall count can not be started until a pivot point is established at the nearest location on the goal line. If the foul is contested, the disc is returned to the thrower.

16.3. **Strip Fouls:**

16.3.1. A Strip Foul occurs when an opponent fouls a player and that causes the player to drop a disc they caught or to lose possession of the disc.

16.3.2. If the reception would have otherwise been a goal, and the foul is accepted, a goal is awarded.

16.4. **Blocking Fouls:**

16.4.1. A Blocking Foul occurs when a player takes a position that an opponent moving in a legal manner will be unable to avoid, taking into account the opponents expected position based on their established speed and direction, and non-minor contact results. This is to be treated as either a receiving foul or an indirect foul, whichever is applicable.

16.5. **Force-out Fouls:**

16.5.1. A Force-out Foul occurs when a receiver is in the process of establishing possession of the disc, and is fouled by a defensive player before subsequently establishing possession, and the contact caused the receiver:

16.5.1.1. to catch the disc out-of-bounds instead of in-bounds; or

16.5.1.2. to catch the disc in the central zone instead of their attacking end zone.

16.5.2. If the receiver would have caught the disc in their attacking end zone, it is a goal;

16.5.3. If the force-out foul is contested, the disc is returned to the thrower if the receiver became out- of-bounds, otherwise the disc stays with **the receiver.**

16.6. **Defensive Throwing (Marking) Fouls:**

16.6.1. A Defensive Throwing Foul occurs when:

16.6.1.1. There is non-minor contact between the thrower and an illegally positioned defensive player; or

16.6.1.2. A defensive player initiates non-minor contact with the thrower, or there is non-minor contact resulting from the thrower and the defender both vying for the same unoccupied position, prior to the thrower releasing the pass.

16.6.1.3. If a Defensive Throwing Foul occurs prior to the thrower releasing the pass and not during the throwing motion, the thrower may choose to call a contact infraction, by calling "**Contact**". After a contact infraction that is not contested, play does not stop and the marker must resume the stall count at one (1).

16.7. **Offensive Throwing (Thrower) Fouls:**

16.7.1. An Offensive Throwing Foul occurs when the thrower is solely responsible for initiating non-minor contact with a defensive player who is in a legal position.

16.7.2. Contact occurring during the thrower's follow through is not a sufficient basis for a foul, but should be avoided.

16.8. **Indirect Fouls:**

16.8.1. An Indirect Foul occurs when there is non-minor contact between a receiver and a defensive player that does not directly affect an attempt to make a play on the disc.

16.8.1.1. Prior to making the "Indirect Foul" call, the player may delay the call up to two (2) seconds to determine if the breach will affect the play.

16.8.2. If the foul is accepted the fouled player may make up any positional disadvantage caused by the foul.

16.9. **Offsetting Fouls:**

16.9.1. If accepted fouls are called by offensive and defensive players on the same play, these are offsetting fouls, and the disc must be returned to the last non-disputed thrower.

16.9.2. If there is non-minor contact that is caused by two or more opposing players moving towards a single point simultaneously, this must be treated as offsetting fouls.

16.9.2.1. However if this occurs after the disc has been caught, or after the relevant player/s involved can no longer make a play on the disc, this must be treated as an Indirect Foul.

17. Infractions and Violations

17.1. **Marking Infractions:**

17.1.1. Marking infractions include the following:

17.1.1.1. **"Fast Count"** – the marker:

17.1.1.1.1. starts or continues the stall count illegally,

17.1.1.1.2. does not start or restart the stall count with "Stalling",

17.1.1.1.3. counts in less than one second intervals,

17.1.1.1.4. does not correctly reduce or reset the stall count when required, or does not start the stall count from the correct number.

17.1.1.2. **"Straddle"** – a line between a defensive player's feet comes within one disc diameter of the thrower's pivot point.

17.1.1.3. **"Disc Space"** – any part of a defensive player is less than one disc diameter away from the torso of the thrower. However, if this situation is caused solely by movement of the thrower, it is not an infraction.

17.1.1.4. **"Wrapping"** – a line between a defensive player's hands or arms comes within one disc diameter of the thrower's torso, or any part of the defensive player's body is above the thrower's pivot point. However, if this situation is caused solely by movement of the thrower, it is not an infraction.

17.1.1.5. "**Double Team**" – a defensive player other than the marker is within three (3) metres of the thrower's pivot point without also guarding another offensive player.

17.1.1.5.1. The defender guarding another offensive player can attempt to prevent a pass from the thrower, as long as they continue to guard another offensive player.

17.1.1.5.2. Merely running across this area is not a double team.

17.1.1.6. **"Vision"** – a defensive player uses any part of their body to intentionally obstruct the thrower's vision.

17.1.1.7. A marking infraction may be contested by the defence, in which case play stops. If a pass has been completed, a contested or retracted marking infraction must be treated as a violation by the offence, and the disc must be returned to the thrower.

17.1.2. Instead of calling a marking infraction, the relevant player may call a marking violation and stop play if;

17.1.2.1. the stall count is not corrected,

17.1.2.2. there is no stall count,

17.1.2.3. there is an egregious marking infraction, or

17.1.2.4. there is a pattern of repeated marking infractions.

17.2. **"Travel" Infractions:**

17.2.1. After catching the disc, the thrower must reduce speed as quickly as possible, without changing direction, until they have established a pivot point.

17.2.1.1. However if a player catches the disc while running or jumping the player may release a pass without attempting to reduce speed and without establishing a pivot point, provided that:

17.2.1.1.1. they do not change direction or increase speed until they release the pass; and a maximum of two additional points of contact with the ground are made after the catch and before they release the pass.

17.2.2. The thrower may move in any direction (pivot) only by establishing and maintaining a pivot point until releasing a pass.

17.2.3. A thrower who is not standing can use any part of their body as the pivot point.

17.2.3.1. If they stand up it is not a travel, but only if a pivot point is established at the same location.

17.2.4. A travel infraction occurs if:

17.2.4.1. the thrower establishes a pivot point at an incorrect location, including by not reducing speed as quickly as possible after a catch, or changing direction after a catch;
17.2.4.2. anytime the thrower must move to a specified location, the thrower does not establish a pivot point before a wind-up or throwing motion begins;
17.2.4.3. the thrower fails to keep the established pivot point until releasing a pass;
17.2.4.4. a player intentionally bobbles, fumbles or delays the disc to themselves, for the sole purpose of moving in a specific direction.

17.2.5. After an accepted travel infraction is called ("travel"), play does not stop.
17.2.5.1. The thrower establishes a pivot point at the correct location, as indicated by the player who called the travel. This must occur without delay from either player involved.
17.2.5.2. Any stall count is paused, and the thrower may not throw the disc, until a pivot point is established at the correct location.
17.2.5.3. The marker does not need to say "Stalling" before resuming the stall count.

17.2.6. If, after a travel infraction but before correcting the pivot point, the thrower throws a completed pass, the defensive team may call a travel violation. Play stops and the disc is returned to the thrower. The thrower must return to the location occupied at the time of the infraction. Play must restart with a check.
17.2.7. If, after a travel infraction, the thrower throws an incomplete pass, play continues.
17.2.8. After a contested travel infraction where the thrower has not released a pass, play stops.

17.3. **"Pick" Violations:**
17.3.1. If a defensive player is guarding one offensive player and they are prevented from moving towards/with that player by another player, that defensive player may call "**Pick**". However it is not a pick if both the player being guarded and the obstructing player are making a play on the disc at the time of the obstruction.
17.3.1.1. Prior to making the "Pick" call, the defender may delay the call up to two (2) seconds to determine if the obstruction will affect the play.
17.3.2. If play has stopped, the obstructed player may move to the agreed position they would have otherwise occupied if the obstruction had not occurred, unless specified otherwise.
17.3.3. All players should take reasonable efforts to avoid the occurrence of picks.

18. Stoppages

18.1. During any stoppage opposing players may agree to slightly adjust their locations to avoid potential picks.

18.2. **Injury Stoppage**
18.2.1. An injury stoppage, "**Injury**", may be called by the injured player, or by any player on the injured player's team.
18.2.2. If the injury was not caused by an opponent, the player must choose either to be substituted, or to charge their own team with a time-out.
18.2.3. If the injury was caused by an opponent, the player may choose to stay or to be substituted.
18.2.4. If the injured player had established possession of the disc, and the player has dropped the disc due to the injury, that player retains possession of the disc.
18.2.5. The injury stoppage is considered to have been called at the time of the injury, unless the injured player chooses to continue play before the stoppage is called.
18.2.6. If the disc was in the air when the injury stoppage was called, play continues until either a player establishes possession, or the disc hits the ground. If the injury is not the result of a foul by an opponent, the completion or turnover stands, and play restarts there after the stoppage.

18.3. **Technical Stoppage**
18.3.1. Any player who recognises a condition that endangers players, including if a player has an open or bleeding wound, should call a technical stoppage by calling "technical" or "stop". Play must stop immediately.
18.3.2. The thrower may call a technical stoppage during play to replace a severely damaged disc.
18.3.3. After a technical stoppage called while the disc is in the air, or if play has continued unknowingly:
18.3.3.1. If the call or issue did not affect play, the completion or turnover stands, and play restarts there;
18.3.3.2. If the call or issue did affect the play, the disc goes back to the thrower.

18.4. If a player is substituted after an injury, or due to illegal or faulty equipment, the opposing team may also choose to substitute one player.
   18.4.1. Substitute players take on the full state (location, possession, stall count etc) of the player they are substituting and may make a call on their behalf.

19. Time-Outs

19.1. Each team has one time out per match.

19.2. Only the player with the disk may call the time-out.

19.3. The player calling a time-out must form a "T" with their hands, or with one hand and the disc, and should call "**time-out**" to opposition players.

19.4. After the pull only a thrower with possession of the disc may call a time-out. The time-out starts when the "T" is formed, and lasts seventy-five (75) seconds. After such a time-out:
   19.4.1. Substitutions are not allowed, except for injury.
   19.4.2. Play is restarted at the pivot location.
   19.4.3. The thrower must remain the same.
   19.4.4. All other offensive players must establish a stationary position, at any location.
   19.4.5. Once the offensive players have selected positions, defensive players must then establish a stationary position, at any location.
   19.4.6. The stall count restarts at maximum nine (9). However if the marker has been switched, the stall count restarts at "Stalling one (1)"

20. Continuation after a Call

20.1. Whenever a foul or violation call is made, or a player attempts to stop play in any way, play stops immediately and no turnover is possible.

20.2. If a foul or violation:
   20.2.1. is called against the thrower and the thrower attempts a pass, or
   20.2.2. is called by the thrower during the act of throwing, or
   20.2.3. is called or occurs when the disc is in the air, then play continues until possession has been established.
   20.2.4. Once possession has been established:
      20.2.4.1. If the team that called the foul or violation gains or retains possession as a result of the pass, the play stands. Play can continue without a stoppage if the player who made the foul or violation call makes a "**Play on**" call as soon as possible.
      20.2.4.2. If the team that called the foul or violation does not gain or retain possession as a result of the pass, play must be stopped. If the team that called the foul or violation believes that possession has been affected by the foul or violation, the disc will be returned to the thrower for a check (unless the specific rule says otherwise).

20.3. Regardless of when any call is made, if the players involved from both teams agree that the event or call did not affect the outcome, the play stands. This rule is not superseded by any other rule.
   20.3.1. If the play resulted in a goal, the goal stands.
   20.3.2. If the play did not result in a goal the affected players may make up any positional disadvantage caused by the event or call and restart play with a check.

Definitions

Term	Definition
Foul	A breach of the rules due to non-minor contact between two or more opposing players. Initiating minor contact intentionally is treated as a violation, not a foul.
Violation	Any breach of the rules (other than a foul or infraction). Often causes a stoppage. Examples include leaving an incorrect pivot location uncontested or offside on the pull.
Stall Count / "Stalling"	The count from one (1) to ten (10) stated by the marker to force a timely throw. If the marker reaches "ten," that can result in a stall-out turnover.
Travel	An infraction involving illegal movement of the pivot (including changing direction before establishing a pivot), or releasing a pass on the run without meeting stopping/slowing requirements.
Pivot / Pivot Location	Once the thrower establishes a pivot point on the field, they must maintain that point until releasing the disc. The "pivot location" is the designated spot where the pivot must be placed or returned to after a turnover or pull.
Infraction	A type of rule breach concerning marking or travel. Infractions typically do not stop play immediately unless contested or escalated as a violation.
Pick	A violation in which a defender is prevented from moving with (or toward) the offensive player they are covering because another player obstructs their path (unintentionally or otherwise), and the obstruction affects the play.
Time-out	A 75-second stoppage called by the thrower in possession (or by either team prior to signaling readiness for the pull). Allows teams to regroup; substitutions depend on *when* it's called.
Contest	A formal disagreement with a foul, infraction, or violation call. The word "Contest" is used, and typically play stops and is resumed with a check (unless continuation rules apply).
Dangerous Play	Actions or behavior that demonstrate reckless disregard for safety, or significant risk of injury, are considered dangerous play. Must be treated as a foul, regardless of whether contact occurs.
Breach	A general term covering all rule-breaking actions in Ultimate (foul, violation, or infraction). Once accepted as having occurred, a breach typically stops play unless continuation rules allow play to proceed.
Brick	An option after the pull sails out of bounds (without first landing in-bounds). The offense can take the disc to the brick mark (usually signalled by raising one arm overhead and calling "brick") before picking up the disc.
Check	The formal restart of play after a stoppage. Performed by a defensive player touching the disc or the thrower tapping it to the ground and calling "Disc In."
Minor Contact	Contact that involves minimal physical force and does not alter the movement or position of another player. Does not normally constitute a foul, yet it must still be minimized.
Marker	The defensive player who guards the thrower and administers the stall count. Has specific distance, stance, and disc-space restrictions.
Offensive Player / Defensive Player	Offensive players are those whose team is in possession of the disc; defenders try to force a turnover. Each has distinct roles related to marking, receiving, and establishing/contesting possession.
Out-of-Bounds	Refers to everything beyond the perimeter lines. Offense retains or establishes possession in-bounds; contact with out-of-bounds areas can cause a turnover if it happens before a receiver fully establishes possession in-bounds.

Receiving Foul / Throwing Foul	Subsets of fouls. A receiving foul is non-minor contact before/during/just after a play on the disc. A throwing foul is illegal contact between the thrower and marker (or vice versa) that disrupts the throwing motion or occurs when the marker is not in a legal position.
Turnover	Any event resulting in a change of possession (e.g., incomplete pass, stall-out, out-of-bounds, interception, etc.).
Possession of the Disc	Established when a player fully catches and maintains control of a non-spinning disc, or when a disc at rest is picked up by a player. The team whose player has possession is on offense.
Catch	Occurs when a player secures a non-spinning disc between at least two body parts and maintains that control through all related ground contact (or until they throw).
Player	Any individual currently participating in the point on the field of play (as opposed to non-players like coaches or sideline personnel). Each player is responsible for knowing and applying the rules.
Playing Field	The rectangular in-bounds area, consisting of the central zone plus two end zones, but excluding all boundary lines.
Attacking End Zone / Defending End Zone	Each team attacks one end zone while defending the opposite one. A goal is scored when a player in possession of the disc is fully in their attacking end zone.
Call	The clearly stated declaration that a foul, violation, infraction, turnover, or injury has occurred. Must be made immediately after recognizing the breach.
Stall-Out	A turnover that occurs if the thrower fails to release the disc before the marker says the word “ten” in the stall count.
Best Perspective	The most complete viewpoint on a play, incorporating relative positions of the disc, ground, and players. Typically, those with the best view are encouraged to share or clarify what they saw during a call.
Pre-stall	A warning mechanism regarding time limits (for instance, after a turnover but before the pivot is established). Warnings may be given at 20, 10, and 5 seconds before the defence can initiate a stall count if the offense delays picking up the disc.
Spirit Stoppage	A stoppage called to discuss issues relating to Spirit of the Game. Usually employed if players or teams feel repeated unsporting behavior or misunderstandings require attention and resolution.

- The End -

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